

Leave Policy

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1. Purpose

This policy defines the types of leave available to TCS employees, eligibility criteria, the number of days permitted, and the procedure for applying for and approving leave. It ensures fair and consistent treatment of leave requests across all departments.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all confirmed and probationary employees of TCS on the India payroll. Employees on international assignment follow the leave policy of the host country where it differs from this document.

3. Definitions

Leave Year	1st January to 31st December.
Casual Leave (CL)	Short-duration leave for personal matters.
Sick Leave (SL)	Leave taken due to illness or medical need.
Earned Leave (EL)	Leave accrued based on service, also called Privilege Leave.
Leave Management System (LMS)	The employee portal module used to apply for and track leave.

4. Types of Leave

Casual Leave (CL)

Employees are entitled to **12 Casual Leave days per calendar year**, credited at the rate of 1 day per completed month of service. CL can be availed for personal errands, family matters, or short personal emergencies. A maximum of 3 consecutive CL days can be taken at a time without prior approval from the department head.

Sick Leave (SL)

Employees are entitled to **10 Sick Leave days per calendar year**. For sick leave exceeding 2 consecutive days, a medical certificate from a registered practitioner must be uploaded in the Leave Management System (LMS) within 3 working days of returning to work.

Earned / Privilege Leave (EL)

Confirmed employees accrue **1.5 Earned Leave days per completed month** of service (18 days per year). EL can be availed for planned vacations and must generally be applied at least 7 days in advance. Employees on probation are not eligible to avail EL, though it continues to accrue and becomes available for use upon confirmation.

Maternity Leave

Female employees are entitled to **26 weeks of paid Maternity Leave** for the first two children, in accordance with the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961. For the third child onward, entitlement is 12 weeks. Maternity Leave may commence up to 8 weeks before the expected delivery date. A minimum of 80 days of service in the preceding 12 months is required to be eligible.

Paternity Leave

Male employees are entitled to **15 calendar days of paid Paternity Leave**, to be availed within 3 months of the child's birth or adoption.

Bereavement Leave

Employees may avail up to **5 working days of paid Bereavement Leave** in the event of the death of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, or sibling). This leave does not require advance notice and can be applied for retroactively in the LMS within 5 working days of returning to work.

5. Leave Eligibility

Probationary employees are eligible for CL and SL from the date of joining, credited on a pro-rata basis. EL, Maternity, and Paternity Leave eligibility require the service duration specified for each leave type above. Interns and employees on contracts under 6 months are eligible only for CL and SL, on a pro-rata basis.

6. Leave Application Procedure

All leave must be applied for through the Leave Management System (LMS) on the employee portal, following this process:

- 1 Log in to the LMS and select the leave type, start date, and end date.
- 2 Provide a brief reason for the leave.
- 3 Submit the request, which routes automatically to the Reporting Manager for approval.
- 4 For SL of more than 2 days, upload the medical certificate once available.
- 5 Track approval status in the 'My Leave Requests' section of the LMS.

Planned leave (CL and EL) should be applied for at least 3 working days in advance for CL and 7 working days in advance for EL, to allow for workload planning. Sick leave may be applied for on the day of absence or immediately upon return, by informing the Reporting Manager and marking it in the LMS.

7. Leave Approval Process

The Reporting Manager reviews and approves or rejects leave requests within the LMS, typically within 1 working day for CL/SL and 3 working days for EL requests. If a manager does not act on a request within 5 working days, it is auto-escalated to the HRBP. Leave that overlaps with critical project deadlines may be declined or asked to be rescheduled by the Reporting Manager, with reasons documented in the LMS.

Taking leave without submitting a request and receiving approval in the LMS — even if informally communicated over chat or email — is treated as unauthorized absence under the Attendance and Working Hours Policy (TCS-HR-003) and may result in loss of pay for the period of absence and disciplinary action for repeated occurrences.

8. Carry-Forward Rules

Unused Casual Leave **cannot be carried forward** and lapses at the end of the calendar year. Unused Earned Leave can be carried forward up to a maximum accumulation of **60 days**; any EL balance beyond 60 days at year-end is automatically encashed as per the Leave Encashment Rules below. Sick Leave can be carried forward up to a maximum of 15 days.

9. Leave Encashment Rules

Employees may encash up to 50% of their unused Earned Leave balance once per financial year, subject to a minimum EL balance of 10 days remaining after encashment. Encashment requests are submitted via the LMS and processed with the following month's payroll. Upon resignation or termination, all unused EL is encashed and paid out as part of the full and final settlement; unused CL and SL are not encashable and lapse on the last working day.

10. Holidays Falling During Leave

If a declared company holiday or weekly off falls within a period of approved leave, that day is not counted against the employee's leave balance. For example, if an employee takes EL from Thursday to the following

Tuesday and Sunday falls within that range, only 4 days (excluding Sunday) are deducted from the EL balance.

11. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How many casual leaves can an employee take?

A: Employees are entitled to 12 Casual Leave days per calendar year, credited monthly at 1 day per month of service.

Q: How much casual time off does an employee get every year?

A: TCS employees receive 12 days of Casual Leave every calendar year, in addition to 10 Sick Leave days and 18 Earned Leave days per year.

Q: Can unused leave be carried forward?

A: Casual Leave cannot be carried forward and lapses at year-end. Earned Leave can be carried forward up to 60 days, and Sick Leave up to 15 days.

Q: How do I apply for sick leave?

A: Mark the leave in the Leave Management System (LMS) on the day of absence or upon return, and attach a medical certificate if the sick leave exceeds 2 consecutive days.

Q: What happens if I take leave without getting approval?

A: It is treated as unauthorized absence, which may result in loss of pay and disciplinary action as outlined in the Attendance and Working Hours Policy (TCS-HR-003).

12. Contact Information

Leave Management System	portal.tcs-internal.com/lms
HR Helpdesk	hr.helpdesk@tcs-internal.com Ext. 1100
Payroll Team (for encashment queries)	payroll@tcs-internal.com